

PHASE 1 – IDEATION PHASE

MODULE 1.1 – EMPATHY MAP CANVAS

1.1.1 Introduction

An Empathy Map is used to understand the needs, expectations, experiences, and difficulties of the user. For this project, the primary user is an employee who needs to request a standard laptop for work.

Understanding the employee's experience helps identify the problems in the current procurement process and provides direction for designing an automated solution.

1.1.1 User Persona

Primary User: Employee requesting a standard laptop

The employee requires a laptop to perform work-related activities. The employee expects the procurement process to be simple, quick, and easy to track.

1.1.3 Think and Feel

The employee may think and feel:

- “I need a laptop to start or continue my work.”
- “I want the request process to be simple.”
- “I don't want to wait unnecessarily for approval.”
- “I want to know what is happening with my request.”
- “I should receive updates without repeatedly contacting IT.”

The employee expects the organization to provide a clear and predictable procurement process.

1.1.4 See

The employee may see:

- Different request and approval steps.
- IT and procurement teams handling the request.
- Request status information.
- Notifications and updates.
- Waiting periods between different stages.

If the process is manual, the employee may not clearly understand which stage the request is currently in.

1.1.5 Hear

The employee may hear:

- Approval-related communication.
- Updates from the IT team.
- Procurement-related information.
- Notifications regarding the request.
- Information about laptop availability and fulfilment.

Automated notifications can reduce the need for repeated communication.

1.1.6 Say and Do

The employee generally:

- Identifies the need for a laptop.
- Submits a laptop request.
- Provides the required information.
- Waits for approval.
- Checks the request status.
- Responds if additional information is required.
- Receives the laptop after fulfilment.

The employee expects these activities to happen through a simple and organized process.

1.1.7 Pain Points

The major pain points identified are:

Pain Point	Description
Delays	Manual processing can increase waiting time.
Approval Waiting	Requests may remain pending until approval is completed.
Follow-up	Employees may need to contact teams for updates.
Poor Visibility	The current stage of a request may not always be clear.
Repetitive Work	IT teams may perform the same activities repeatedly.

Communication Gaps Information may not reach the employee at the right time.

1.1.8 Needs and Gains

The employee needs:

- A simple request process.
- Faster processing.
- Automated approval flow.
- Clear request status.
- Timely notifications.
- Less manual follow-up.
- Predictable fulfilment.

The expected gains are better transparency, reduced waiting, and a smoother procurement experience.

1.1.9 Key Insight

The Empathy Map shows that the employee mainly needs a *simple, transparent, and automated laptop procurement process*.

This insight supports the development of the proposed ServiceNow Flow Designer solution, where important activities are automatically triggered and managed.

1.1.10 Conclusion

The Empathy Map helps understand the procurement process from the employee's perspective. By identifying the user's thoughts, actions, pain points, and expectations, the project can focus on solving practical problems.

The insights from this activity support the idea of automating standard laptop orders using ServiceNow Flow Designer.